

echoes of guitar-strumming, castanets, stamping dance rhythms, and flamenco song. The publication of 30 sonatas under the title Exercises in 1638 established Scarlatti's Europe-wide reputation, but little more of his music was published in his lifetime.

Since Scarlatti's death in Madrid in 1757, the rest of the keyboard works have been gradually rediscovered. Although little of his vocal music is highly rated today, Scarlatti's sonatas have an idiosyncratic "modern" feel that guarantees their popular place in the repertoire.



HARPSICHORD FROM 1725

Scarlatti was a master of the harpsichord. In a keyboard competition with Handel in Rome, judges estimated Handel to be superior at the organ but Scarlatti the better harpsichordist. One contemporary described his playing "as if ten hundred devils had been at the instrument."